

Handle Success Like You Handle Failure: Introduction, featuring Doug Buce

Doug Buce, President & CLO, Boeing Dynamics, Inc.

At first glance, you might assume that, for all her records, accolades and accomplishments, Pat Summitt was a winner at every turn. Well, in many regards, she was. But as you're about to find out, Pat learned more from her losses than any of her wins. These difficult and often heartbreaking lessons helped her become the person and championship coach that she was. Without losing, Pat Summitt may never have achieved the level of greatness that she did. And that's a great lesson for all of us in sport and in business. Learn from your losses and failures.

As Pat said, "I've learned more from losing than from winning. If you win, you're not nearly as concerned with your mistakes. I've learned to welcome loss and failure and adversity. Why? Because they erase success. Success lulls you. It makes the most ambitious of us complacent and sloppy. Failure is simple. It gives you a distinct blueprint of where you've gone wrong."

At some point, every great leader must come to understand why failure does not mean disaster and why success does not mean you have 'arrived.' Failure and success have so many lessons to teach us if we are willing to listen and do the hard work of analyzing what made it successful and where we need to improve. No one was more committed to this process of discovery than Pat Summitt. Coach Summitt summarized this ***Definite Dozen*** principle by saying, "You can't always control what happens, but you can control how you handle it." So, let's get started on our journey of discovering how to handle success like you handle failure.